

PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

v2024.1

Tracking data

CIM code	MAR-ART 2, MAR-ART3
Program name	Master of Architecture
year	2025
Program assessment coordinator	Martin Felsen, Director M Arch Program
Assessment plan year	2024/25
No assessment this year per plan	Students will understand professional ethics, regulatory requirements, approaches to leadership in multidisciplinary teams and fundamental business processes relevant to architecture practice in the United States, and the forces influencing change in these subjects.
LO(s) assessed	Learning Objective 1
Presented at program authority meeting date: <i>Please attach minutes</i>	Wednesday, September 10

Methodology + Artifact Description

Learning Objective 1

Students will understand professional ethics, regulatory requirements, approaches to leadership in multidisciplinary teams and fundamental business processes relevant to architecture practice in the United States, and the forces influencing change in these subjects.

In ARCH 413 / 568 and LA 514 Professional Practice Learning Objective 1 is explored through the following exercises:

1. Introduce the student to the business and management principles of architectural practice.
2. Present the fundamental managerial processes associated with architectural projects.
3. Have students negotiate the regulatory requirements associated with architectural practices and projects.
4. Contemplate professional ethics, and the ethical challenges that we are faced with in practice.

Exercise 1

The process of starting and running a firm including conversations about legal requirements, insurance, business structures and business planning.

Assignment 1: Develop a business plan for your new firm.

Rubric / Methodology:

- a. Confirm depth of exploration through number of variables that have been contemplated.
- b. Confirm fee multipliers are within competitive ranges based on type of case study firm.
- c. Graduate specific criteria: Be able to discuss how multipliers are specific to firm typologies.

Exercise 2

Presentation of the different business strategies for finding and procuring new work. Discussions regarding how to present your firm and qualifications, write proposals and then establish fees for jobs.

Assignment 2: Calculate a fee for your case study project and write a proposal from your new firm to deliver your studio project including a fee.

Rubric / Methodology:

- a. Confirm depth of exploration through number of variables that have been contemplated.
- b. Confirm established fee is competitive and within the range for the type of case study firm and project.
- c. Graduate specific criteria: Evaluate clarity of written proposal.

Exercise 3

Introduction and review of the most common contracts used to deliver architectural projects.

Assignment 3: Read A201 Document

Complete B101 Contract Document

Complete C401 Consultant Contract

Rubric / Methodology:

- a. Confirm depth of contractual variables explored within the documents.
- b. Graduate specific criteria: Annotate A201 document.

Introduction to building, zoning and accessibility code value and purpose and workshop to perform building code analysis on your current design studio project.

Assignment 4: Complete Code Analysis on current design studio project.

Rubric / Methodology:

- a. Confirm correct code interpretations.

Exercise 4

Introduction to professional ethics and review of the AIA Professional Code of Ethics.

Describe three situations in a professional environment that would bring into question your professional ethics and note the section of the AIA Professional Code of Ethics that apply.

Rubric / Methodology:

- a. Evaluate depth of consideration with potential ethics responses.
- b. Graduate specific criteria: Be able to discuss a an actual professional ethics example.

Results

Description of Findings

The majority of students meet expectations or are proficient at achieving the learning objective. The variety of exercises test proficiency in a multitude of ways, and most students are able to understand the concepts and deliver adequate work samples. With this specific Learning Objective, understanding the differences between meeting expectations and proficiency is nuanced.

With little ability to teach these lessons recursively, or refine results through iteration, students are asked to investigate discreet topics only once per semester, without returning to further test comprehension.

Continuous Improvement

Over the last several semesters we have adjusted the exercises to include more in class workshops to allow students the opportunities to work through the exercises collectively, individually and in groups, with the opportunities to share findings, ask questions, and adjust criteria and variables.

For the last five years, we have taught the course following the arc of starting a firm and obtaining/completing a project, allowing students to start a fictional project and work on a fictional project of their choosing. To tighten the wide variety of responses we receive, this semester we have implemented a reduced and fixed set of case studies for the students to pursue.

CLASS	STUDENT	TOTAL (200)	%	D, M, P
568		155	77.50%	M
568		210	105.00%	P

D	0	0%
M	1	50%
P	1	50%

